

PROJECT REPORT

STREAMLINING IT PROCUREMENT: AUTOMATING STANDARD LAPTOP ORDERS WITH FLOW DESIGNER

Submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the SmartBridge Project
Development Program

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INSTITUTION:

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Date of Submission: _____

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Problem Statement:

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders. Requests for standard laptops often require configuration, but this step is prone to oversight or delay, leading to frustration among users and inefficient resource allocation within the IT department.

User Story:

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the hardware team for configuration. This will ensure that laptops are promptly configured upon arrival, reducing user wait times and minimising manual intervention.

Project Objective:

The objective of this project is to implement an automated workflow using Flow Designer to facilitate the procurement and configuration of standard laptops. By integrating automation into the process, the project aims to:

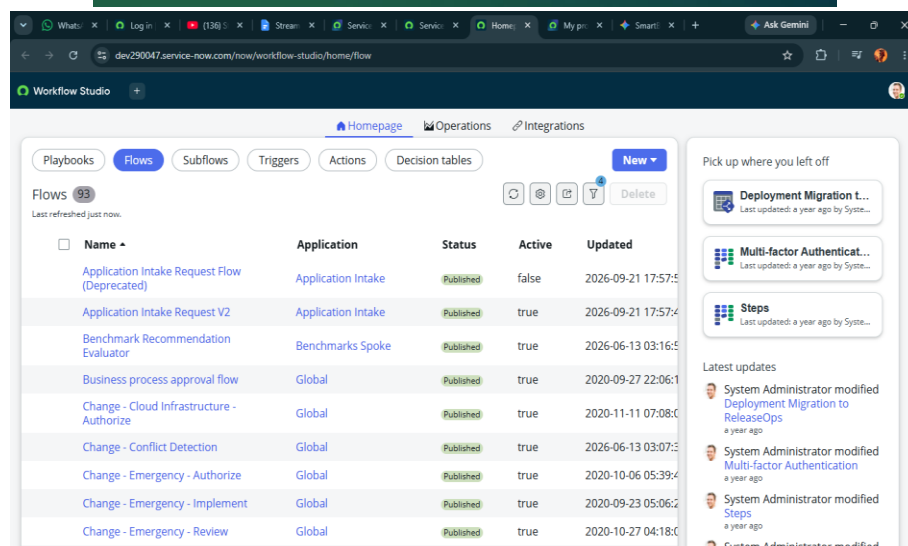
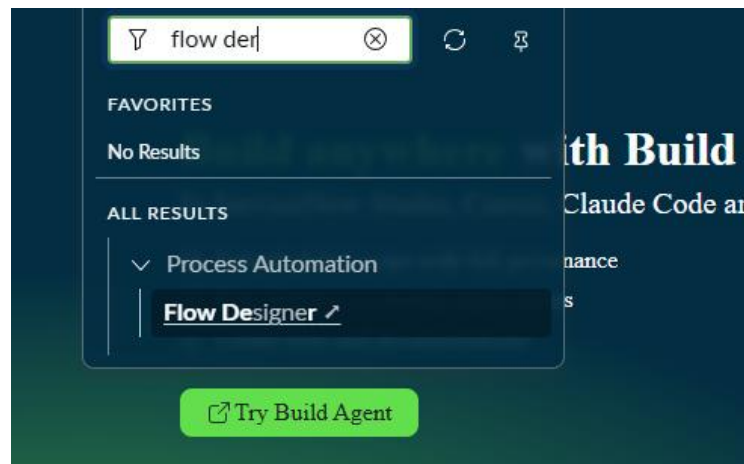
1. Create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops by ensuring timely configuration.
2. Reduce manual intervention and potential errors in the procurement process.
3. Improve resource utilisation within the IT department by optimising task allocation.
4. Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

TASK INITIATION

Milestone 1 : Flow

Activity 1: Create a Flow to Create Catalog task to update the short description after Approval the service Request and it will be Assignment group to Hardware.

1. Open service now.
2. Click on All >> search for Flow Designer
3. Click on Flow Designer under Process Automation.
4. After opening Flow Designer Click on new and select Flow.
5. Under Flow properties Give Flow Name as “ Standard laptop task”.
6. Application should be Global.
7. Select Run user as “ System user ” from that choice.
8. Click on Submit.



Let's get the details for your flow

Name to uniquely identify your flow.

Flow name * ⓘ

Application * ⓘ

Description ⓘ

> [Show additional properties](#)

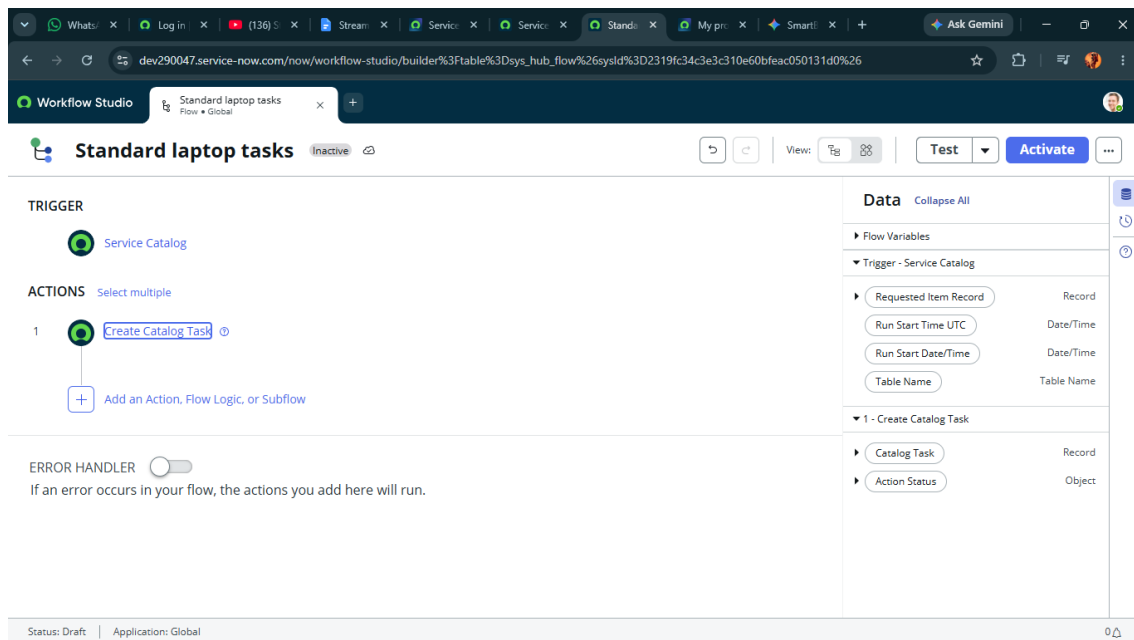
Cancel

Build flow

9. Click on Add a trigger

10. Select the trigger in that Search for “Service Catalog” and select that.

11. After that click on Done.



The screenshot shows the ServiceNow Workflow Studio interface. The browser address bar displays the URL: `dev290047.service-now.com/now/workflow-studio/builder%3Ftable%3Dsys_hub_flow%26sysId%3D2319fc34c3e3c310e60bfeac050131d0%26`. The workflow is titled "Standard laptop tasks" and is currently "Inactive".

TRIGGER

- Service Catalog

ACTIONS *Select multiple*

- Create Catalog Task ⓘ

[+ Add an Action, Flow Logic, or Subflow](#)

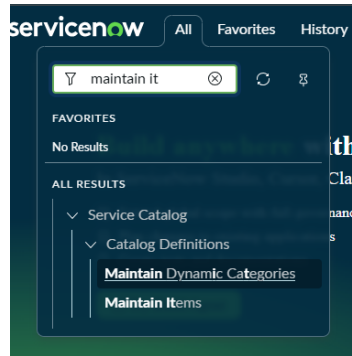
ERROR HANDLER ☐

If an error occurs in your flow, the actions you add here will run.

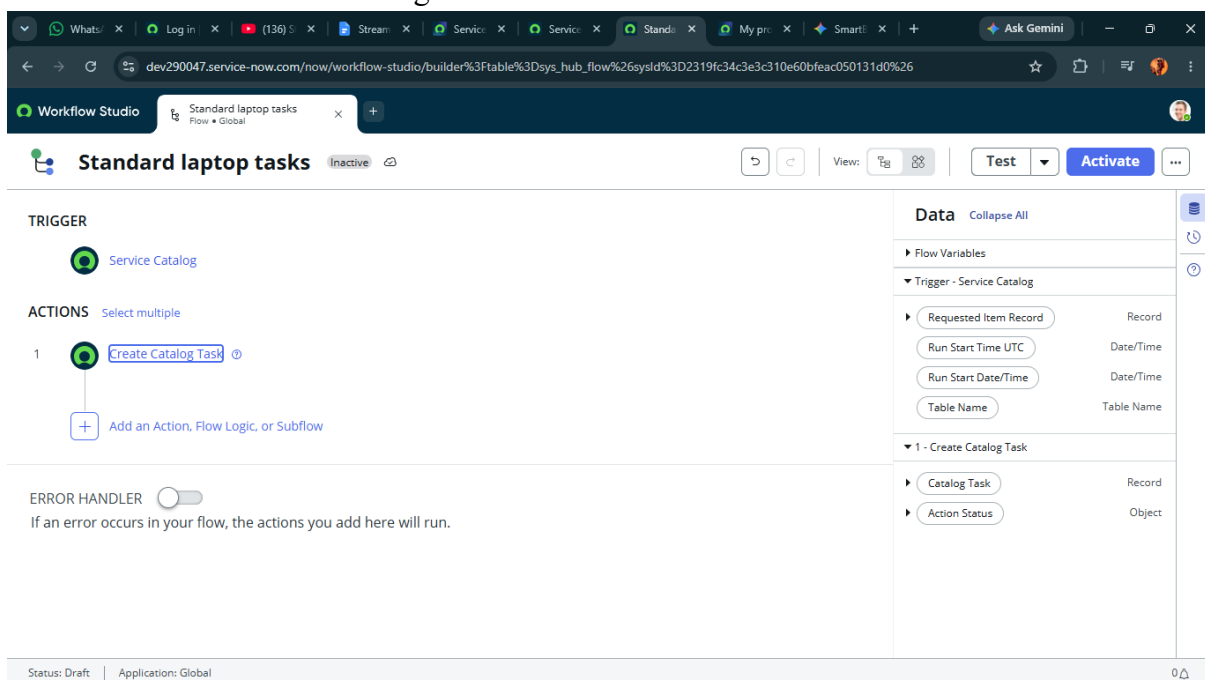
Data *Collapse All*

- Flow Variables
- Trigger - Service Catalog
 - Requested Item Record (Record)
 - Run Start Time UTC (Date/Time)
 - Run Start Date/Time (Date/Time)
 - Table Name (Table Name)
- 1 - Create Catalog Task
 - Catalog Task (Record)
 - Action Status (Object)

Status: Draft | Application: Global



12. Now under Actions.
13. Click on Add an action.
14. Select action in that search for “ Create Catalog Task ” and select that.
15. Mention these in that action
16. Action as Create Catalog Task
17. Drag and drop the Requested Item Record in the Request item.
18. Table will be auto populated as a Catalog Task.
19. Mention the short description as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
20. Click on add field value
21. Select description field and value as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
22. Select Assignment group field and value as “ Hardware ”.
23. Select Approval field and value as “ Approved ”.
24. Leave the remaining as default and click on Done.
25. Click on save the Flow.
26. And Click on Activate again click on Activate.



The screenshot shows the ServiceNow Workflow Studio interface for a flow named "Standard laptop tasks". The flow is currently inactive. The interface includes a search bar at the top with the text "maintain it". Below the search bar, there are tabs for "All", "Favorites", and "History". The "All" tab is selected, showing a list of results under "ALL RESULTS". The results include "Service Catalog", "Catalog Definitions", "Maintain Dynamic Categories", and "Maintain Items".

The main workspace shows the flow configuration. The "TRIGGER" section is set to "Service Catalog". The "ACTIONS" section contains a single action "Create Catalog Task". The "ERROR HANDLER" section is currently empty. The "Data" panel on the right shows the flow variables and the data structure for the "Create Catalog Task" action, including fields like "Requested Item Record", "Run Start Time UTC", "Run Start Date/Time", "Table Name", "Catalog Task", and "Action Status".

At the bottom of the interface, there is a status bar showing "Status: Draft" and "Application: Global".

Standard Laptop task Active View: [icon] [icon] Test De

1 **now** Create Catalog Task ⓘ

Action: Create Catalog Task

Table Name: Catalog Task [sc_task]

* Requested Item [Requested Item]: Trigger - ... ▶ Requested Item ...

Short Description: Laptop needs to Configured

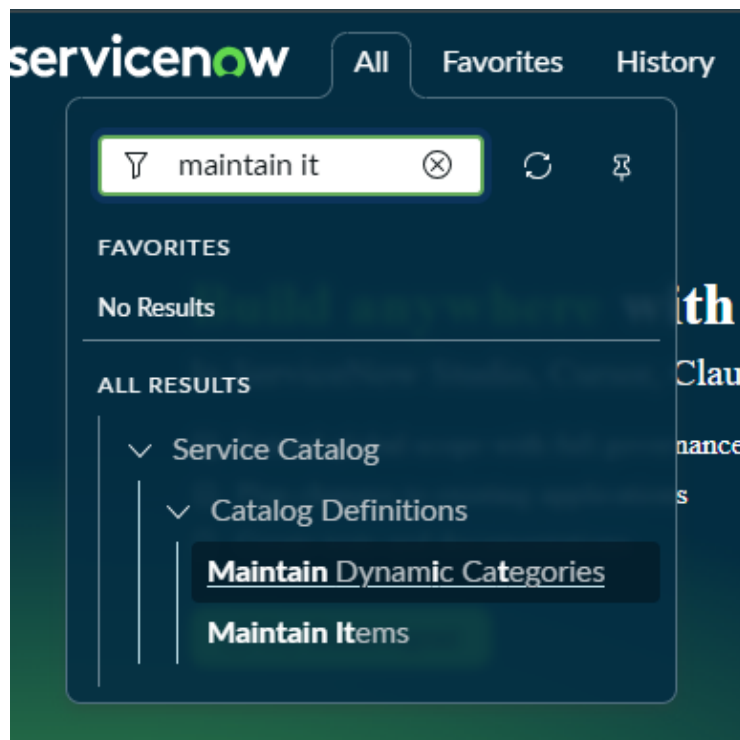
Fields:

Description	Laptop needs to Configured	[icon] [icon] ⊖
Assignment group	Hardware	[icon] [icon] ⊖
Approval	Approved	[icon] [icon] ⊖

+ Add field value

Wait: ☒

Template Catalog: Select Template Catalog Item

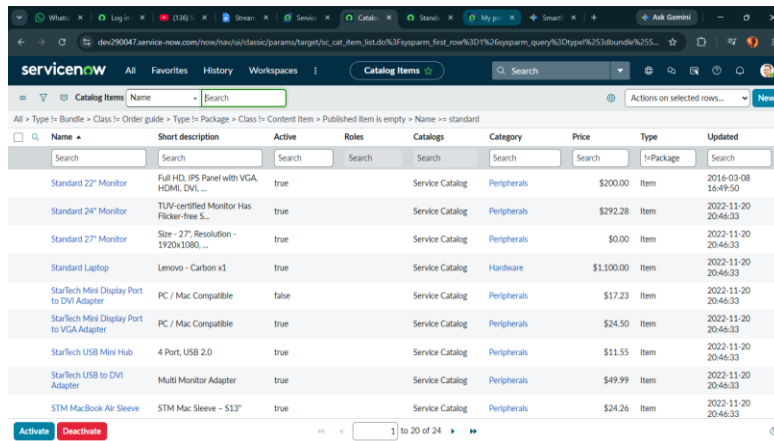


Milestone 2 : Flow assignment

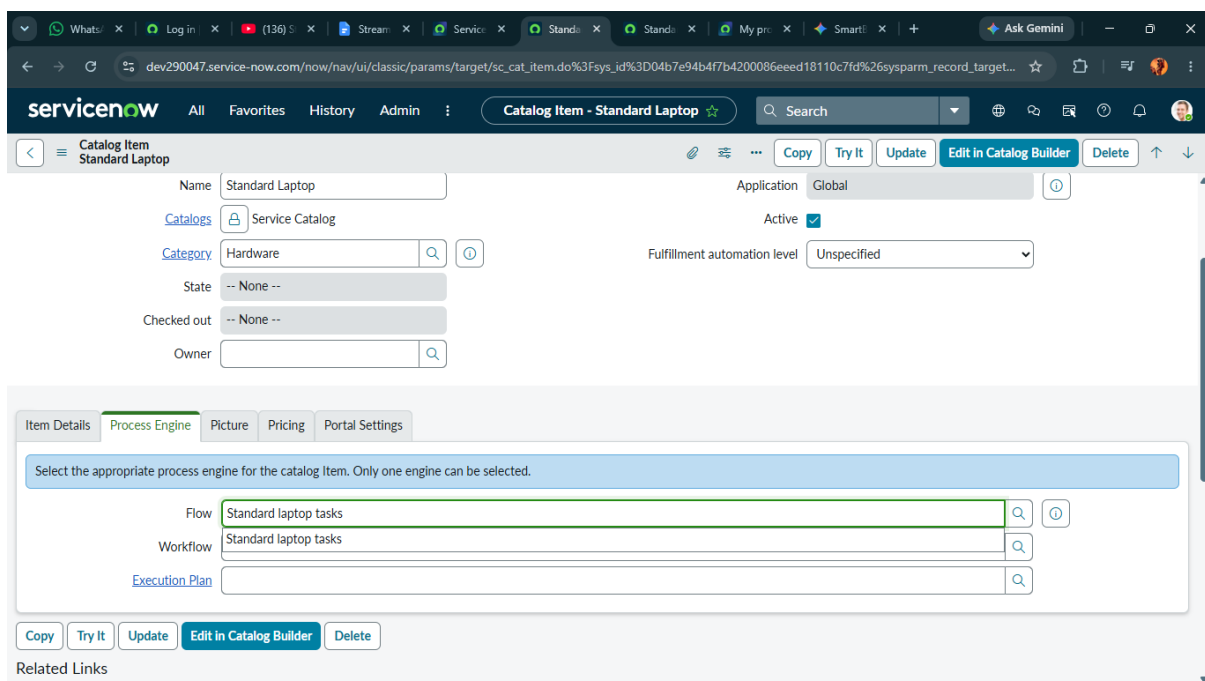
Activity 1 : Flow Assignment to Standard laptop service Catalog.

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click on all search for Maintain Items.
3. Select Maintain Items.

4. Under the name field search for Standard Laptop Select that record.
5. Under that record select Process engine
6. Remove the remaining automations and add Flow.
7. Add the flow that was created with the name “ Standard Laptop Task”.
8. Click on the menu to save the record.



Name	Short description	Active	Roles	Catalogs	Category	Price	Type	Updated
Standard 22" Monitor	Full HD, IPS Panel with VGA, HDMI, DVI, ...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$200.00	Item	2016-03-08 16:49:50
Standard 24" Monitor	TUV-certified Monitor Has Flicker-free S...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$292.28	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33
Standard 27" Monitor	Size - 27", Resolution - 1920x1080, ...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$0.00	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33
Standard Laptop	Lenovo - Carbon x1	true		Service Catalog	Hardware	\$1,100.00	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33
StarTech Mini Display Port to DVI Adapter	PC / Mac Compatible	false		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$17.23	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33
StarTech Mini Display Port to VGA Adapter	PC / Mac Compatible	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$24.50	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33
StarTech USB Mini Hub	4 Port, USB 2.0	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$11.55	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33
StarTech USB to DVI Adapter	Multi Monitor Adapter	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$49.99	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33
STM MacBook Air Sleeve	STM Mac Sleeve - \$13"	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$24.26	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33



Standard Laptop

Application: Global

Active: ☒

Fulfillment automation level: Unspecified

Catalogs: Service Catalog

Category: Hardware

State: -- None --

Checked out: -- None --

Owner:

Item Details | **Process Engine** | Picture | Pricing | Portal Settings

Select the appropriate process engine for the catalog item. Only one engine can be selected.

Flow: Standard laptop tasks

Workflow: Standard laptop tasks

Execution Plan:

Copy Try It Update Edit in Catalog Builder Delete

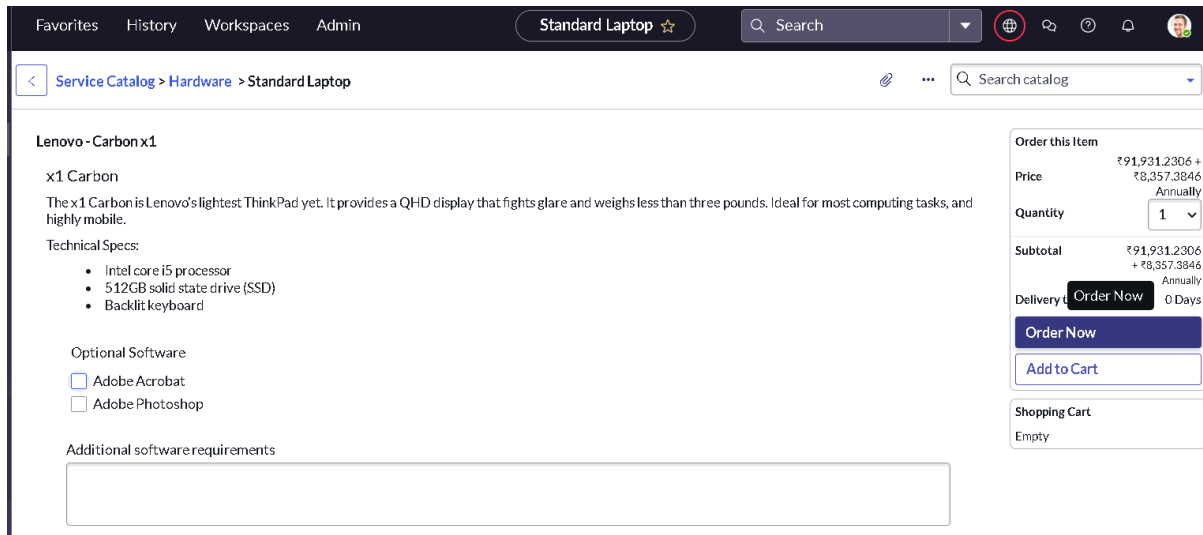
Related Links

Milestone 3 : Service Catalog

Activity 1: Service Catalog for placing order and get Approval

1. Click on All >> Search for “ Service Catalog ”.

2. Click on Service Catalog >> click on Hardware.
3. Scroll a bit to find the “ Standard Laptop ” click on that.
4. After that click on “ Order Now ” to place the request.



Service Catalog > Hardware > Standard Laptop

Lenovo - Carbon x1

x1 Carbon

The x1 Carbon is Lenovo's lightest ThinkPad yet. It provides a QHD display that fights glare and weighs less than three pounds. Ideal for most computing tasks, and highly mobile.

Technical Specs:

- Intel core i5 processor
- 512GB solid state drive (SSD)
- Backlit keyboard

Optional Software

☐ Adobe Acrobat

☐ Adobe Photoshop

Additional software requirements

Order this Item

Price ₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually

Quantity 1

Subtotal ₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually

Delivery 0 Days

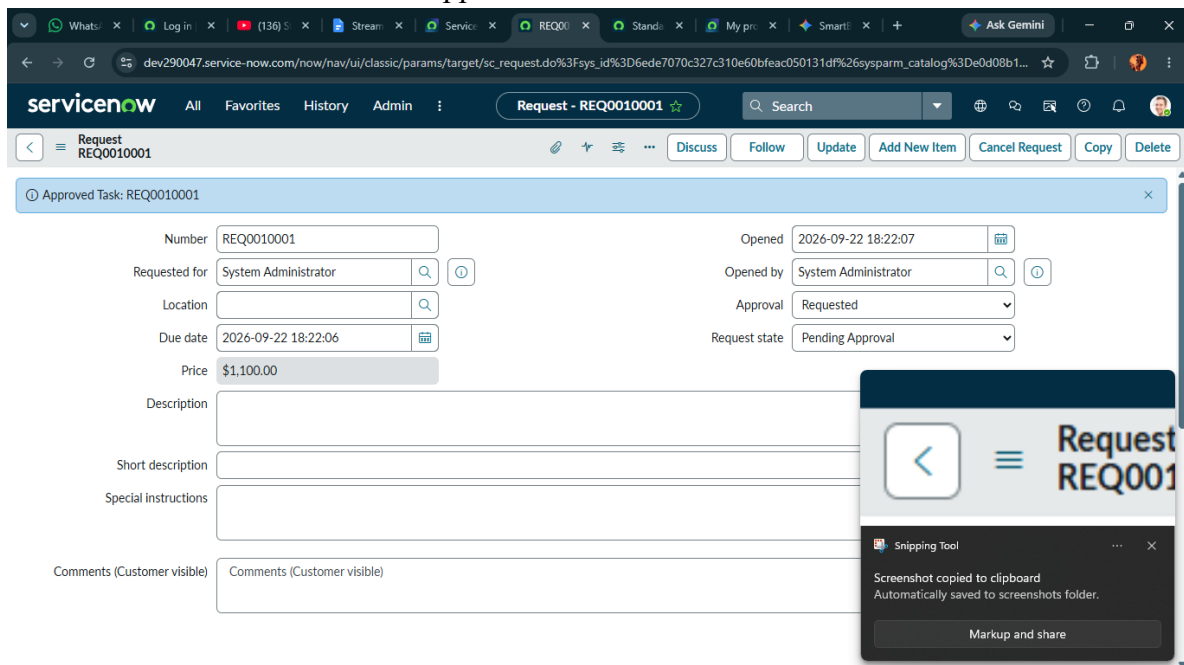
Order Now

Add to Cart

Shopping Cart

Empty

5. Now we will see the Order status
6. In that click on the Request Number
7. It will open the Requested number record.
8. Scroll down Click on the Approvers Section.



Request - REQ0010001

Number REQ0010001

Opened 2026-09-22 18:22:07

Requested for System Administrator

Opened by System Administrator

Location

Approval Requested

Due date 2026-09-22 18:22:06

Request state Pending Approval

Price \$1,100.00

Description

Short description

Special instructions

Comments (Customer visible) Comments (Customer visible)

Request REQ001

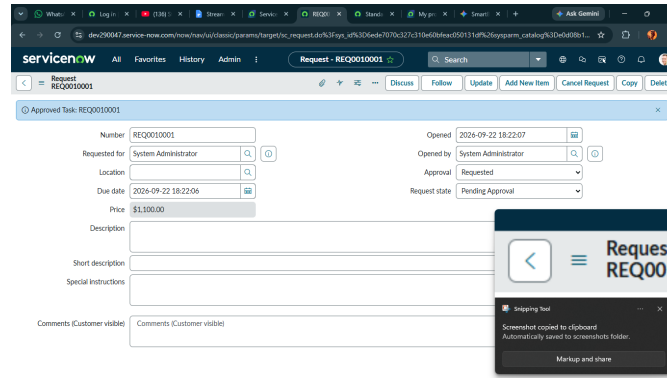
Snipping Tool

Screenshot copied to clipboard

Automatically saved to screenshots folder.

Markup and share

9. Right Click on the Record to see config in that Click on the Approve.



Request - REQ0010001

Number: REQ0010001

Requested for: System Administrator

Location: [Search]

Due date: 2026-09-22 18:22:06

Price: \$1,100.00

Description: [Text Area]

Short description: [Text Area]

Special instructions: [Text Area]

Comments (Customer visible): [Text Area]

Opened: 2026-09-22 18:22:07

Opened by: System Administrator

Approval: Requested

Request state: Pending Approval

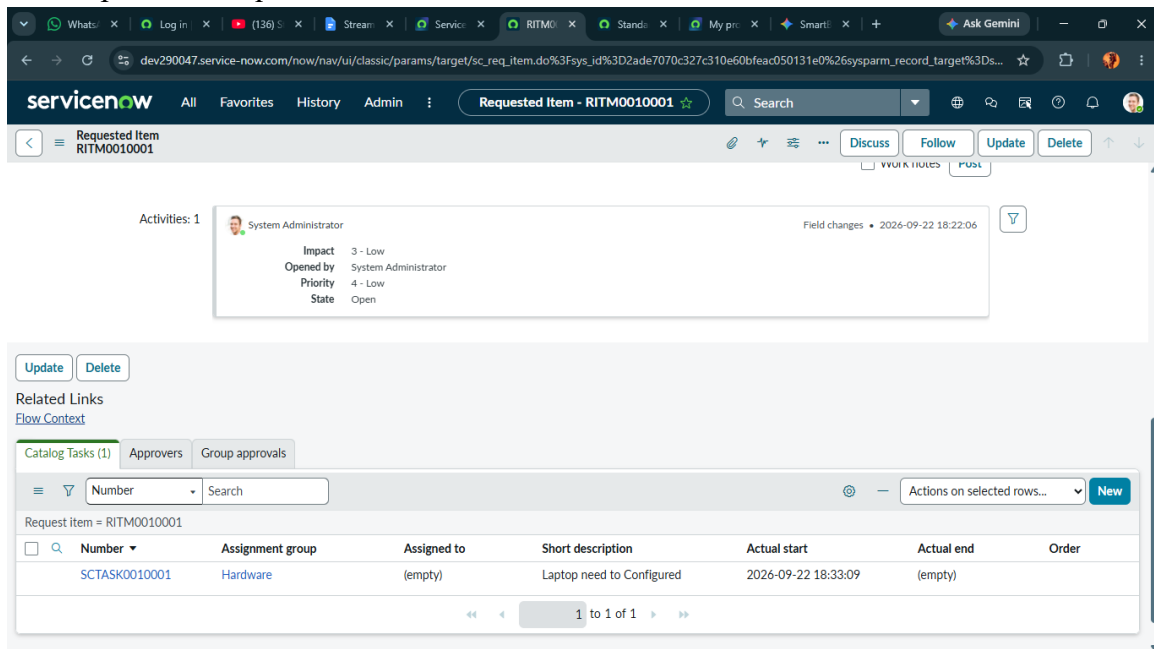
Requesting tool: [Dropdown]

Screenshot copied to clipboard. Automatically saved to screenshots folder.

Mark-up and share

10. Then click on the Requested item Section

11. Open that Requested Item record



Requested Item - RITM0010001

Activities: 1

System Administrator

Field changes • 2026-09-22 18:22:06

Impact: 3 - Low

Opened by: System Administrator

Priority: 4 - Low

State: Open

Update Delete

Related Links

Flow Context

Catalog Tasks (1) Approvers Group approvals

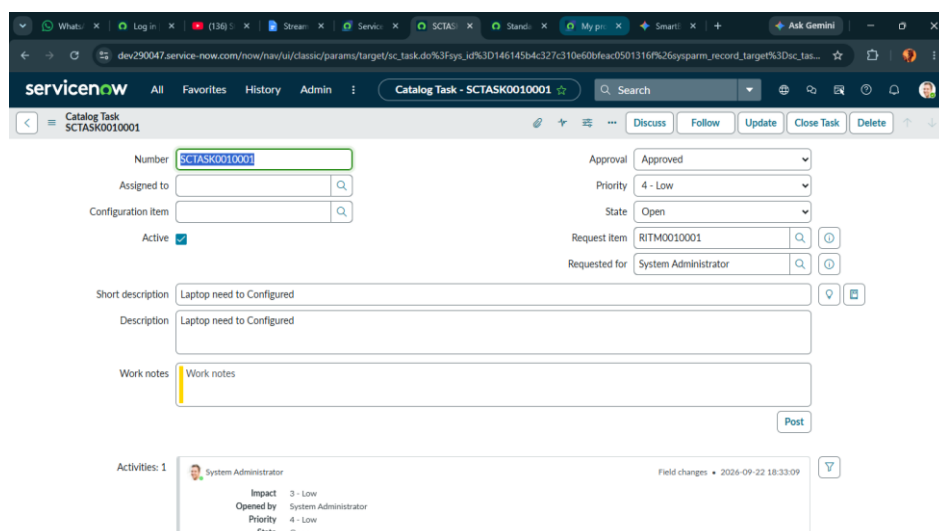
Number Search

Request item = RITM0010001

Number	Assignment group	Assigned to	Short description	Actual start	Actual end	Order
SCTASK0010001	Hardware	(empty)	Laptop need to Configured	2026-09-22 18:33:09	(empty)	1 to 1 of 1

12. Scroll down to the “Catalog tasks ” Section

13. Open the record to see the updated status of the record with Short description and Assigned group.



Catalog Task - SCTASK0010001

Number: SCTASK0010001

Assigned to: [Search]

Configuration item: [Search]

Active: ☒

Approval: Approved

Priority: 4 - Low

State: Open

Request item: RITM0010001

Requested for: System Administrator

Short description: Laptop need to Configured

Description: Laptop need to Configured

Work notes: Work notes

Post

Activities: 1

System Administrator

Field changes • 2026-09-22 18:33:09

Impact: 3 - Low

Opened by: System Administrator

Priority: 4 - Low

State: Open

Conclusion :

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow's Flow Designer, the project effectively addresses inefficiencies and reduces manual overhead. This streamlined workflow ensures timely configuration of laptops, minimizes user wait times, and enhances overall productivity within the IT department. The implementation of this automated solution not only optimizes resource allocation but also significantly improves the user experience by providing a seamless and efficient procurement process.